

IBA & MBA

Admission Preparation Guide

Complete Syllabus · Exam Pattern · Question Types · Preparation Tips

Bangladesh Bank Exam Series | 2025–2026 Edition

2 Programs	4 Sections	100 Total Marks	120 BBA Seats	~60 MBA Seats
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TABLE OF CONTENTS
1. IBA (DU) — About & Overview
2. IBA BBA Admission — Eligibility & Test Pattern
3. IBA BBA — Detailed Syllabus (All Sections)
4. IBA MBA Admission — Eligibility & Test Pattern
5. IBA MBA — Detailed Syllabus (All Sections)
6. IBA EMBA — Pattern & Eligibility
7. Other Top MBA Institutions in Bangladesh
8. Exam Comparison Table

9. Preparation Strategy & Tips

10. AI/Data Collection Plan for Exam Prep

SECTION 1 — About IBA, University of Dhaka

The **Institute of Business Administration (IBA)**, University of Dhaka, is the most prestigious business school in Bangladesh. Established in 1966, IBA was the **first business school in Bangladesh to offer an MBA program**. It consistently ranks as the top business school in the country and produces graduates who lead Bangladesh's banking, finance, MNC, and public sectors.

Program	Duration	Seats	Mode
BBA (Bachelor of Business Administration)	4 Years	120	Full-time
MBA (Regular)	2 Years	~60	Full-time / Evening
Executive MBA (EMBA)	2 Years	Varies	Weekend (Fri–Sat)
M.Phil / Ph.D.	3–5 Years	Limited	Research

Website: www.iba-du.edu | Admission Portal: admission.eis.du.ac.bd

SECTION 2 — IBA BBA Admission

2.1 Eligibility Criteria

Category	Requirement
SSC + HSC (Bangladesh Board)	Minimum combined GPA 8.00 (including 4th subject) Minimum GPA 3.5 in each of SSC and HSC separately HSC passed in the year of application only
O-Level + A-Level	Passed IGCSE/O-Level in at least 5 subjects (Math compulsory) Passed IAL/GCE A-Level in at least 2 subjects Minimum 2 A grades among 7 subjects Minimum average grade point 3.5 in both O-Level and A-Level Equivalence certificate from Dhaka University required
Restriction	Cannot have appeared in any DU admission test before (including IBA) All Bangladeshi applicants must sit for the admission test
Seats	120 (merit-based, strictly competitive)
Application Fee	Tk. 1,500 (online payment)

2.2 Admission Test Structure

The BBA admission test has **two components**: a Written Test and a Communication Test. Candidates must pass the Written Test to be called for the Communication Test. Minimum qualifying scores are required in each section separately.

Component	Section	Questions	Marks	Time	Negative Marking
Written Test	English Language	30 MCQ	30	~30 min	-0.25 per wrong
Written Test	Mathematics	30 MCQ	30	~30 min	-0.25 per wrong
Written Test	Analytical Ability	15–20 MCQ	15–20	~30 min	-0.25 per wrong
Written Test	Writing (Essay/Para)	1–2 tasks	20–25	30 min	No negative
Communication Test	Oral/Viva	Panel Interview	—	15 min	Shortlisted only

Important: The MCQ section runs for 90 minutes total. You may distribute your time freely across sections. No calculator is allowed. Calculators are strictly prohibited.

SECTION 3 — IBA BBA Detailed Syllabus

3.1 English Language (30 Marks)

Level: Class 9–10 / O-Level standard. Tests language aptitude, NOT advanced literature.

Topic Area	Sub-topics / Question Types	Expected Questions
Vocabulary & Word Meaning	Synonyms, Antonyms, Word-in-context, One-word substitution	6–8
Grammar	Tense, Subject-Verb Agreement, Articles, Prepositions, Conjunctions, Pronouns	6–8
Sentence Correction	Error identification, Correct sentence selection, Grammatical error spotting	5–7
Reading Comprehension	Short passage (200–300 words), Inference, Main idea, Vocabulary in context	4–6
Fill in the Blanks	Grammar-based blanks, Vocabulary-based blanks, Cloze test style	4–6
Idioms & Phrases	Meaning of common idioms, Correct usage	2–3

3.2 Mathematics (30 Marks)

Level: Class 9–10 / O-Level standard. No calculus. No calculator allowed.

Topic Area	Sub-topics	Expected Questions
Arithmetic	Number system, LCM/GCF, Percentage, Ratio & Proportion, Profit & Loss, Simple & Compound Interest, Time-Speed-Distance, Time & Work, Average	10–12
Algebra	Linear equations (1 & 2 variables), Quadratic equations, Inequalities, Word problems, Indices & surds	8–10
Geometry	Lines & angles, Triangles (area, Pythagoras), Circles (area, circumference), Quadrilaterals, Coordinate geometry basics	5–7
Data Interpretation	Reading tables, bar charts, pie charts, line graphs; Calculating percentages, ratios, averages from data	3–5
Data Sufficiency	Two-statement data sufficiency problems (GMAT style)	2–4

3.3 Analytical Ability (15–20 Marks)

No fixed syllabus. Tests pure logical reasoning and problem-solving aptitude.

Type	Description
Number / Letter Series	Find the next item in a sequence following a pattern
Logical Reasoning	Syllogism (All A are B...), deductive / inductive reasoning
Pattern Recognition	Identify shapes, relationships, odd-one-out
Data Interpretation	Graphs, charts, tables — identify trends and calculate values

Type	Description
Puzzles	Arrangement puzzles, blood-relation problems, direction sense
Critical Reasoning	Strengthen / weaken arguments, assumptions, conclusions

3.4 Writing Section (20–25 Marks)

Task Type	Description	Tips
Essay / Composition	Write a short essay (200–300 words) on a general or social topic	Focus on structure: intro–body–conclusion; use examples
Paragraph Writing	Write a coherent paragraph on a given topic or prompt	Clear topic sentence; 5–8 sentences; good cohesion
Letter / Application	Formal letter writing (complaint, request, inquiry)	Use correct salutation, body, and closing format
Summary / Precis	Summarize a given passage in your own words	Capture main ideas; avoid copying original text
Translation (BBA — rare)	Translate a Bangla passage to English or vice versa	Maintain meaning; use proper grammar and tone

SECTION 4 — IBA MBA Admission (Regular)

4.1 Eligibility Criteria

Category	Requirement
Academic Qualification	Bachelor's degree in any discipline Minimum CGPA 2.50/4.00 (or 2nd Class) Minimum GPA 3.00/5.00 (2nd Division) in both SSC and HSC separately No 3rd Division/Class at any level (SSC/HSC/Bachelor's)
O-Level / A-Level	Minimum GPA 2.00 in both O-Level and A-Level separately
Work Experience	Not mandatory for Regular MBA; advantageous for selection
Application Fee	Tk. 1,000–1,500 (check current circular)
Typical Cycle	Annual — Circular published October–November; Exam in November–December

4.2 MBA Admission Test Structure

The MBA test is a **2-hour written exam (100 marks)** followed by a **Viva Voce (interview)** for shortlisted candidates. A minimum qualifying score is required in each section.

Part	Section	Marks	Duration	Negative Marking
Part 1 — MCQ	English Language & Communication	30	90 min total	–0.25
Part 1 — MCQ	Mathematics	30	(shared)	–0.25
Part 1 — MCQ	Analytical Ability	15	(shared)	–0.25
Part 2 — Written	Essay / Paragraph / Summary	15–25	30 min	None
Final Stage	Viva Voce (Interview)	—	15–20 min	Shortlisted only

Cut-off note: The safe zone is typically 60% per section, but the committee may adjust between 40–60% depending on competition level. Sectional cut-offs are strictly enforced — clearing total alone is not sufficient.

SECTION 5 — IBA MBA Detailed Syllabus

5.1 English Language & Communication (30 Marks)

Topic	Sub-topics	Marks
Vocabulary	Synonyms, Antonyms, Analogies, Word-in-context, Collocations	6–8
Grammar	Advanced grammar — Tense, Voice, Narration, Conditionals, Subject-Verb Agreement, Pronoun reference, Parallelism	6–8
Sentence Correction / Error Detection	Identify grammatically incorrect sentences; Choose the best sentence among options	5–7
Reading Comprehension	Academic/business passage (300–500 words); Inference, tone, specific detail, author's purpose	5–7
Cloze Test	Paragraph with multiple blanks; grammar + vocabulary based	3–5
Sentence Rearrangement	Arrange jumbled sentences into a coherent paragraph	2–4

5.2 Mathematics (30 Marks)

Topic	Sub-topics	Marks
Arithmetic	Percentage, Ratio/Proportion, Profit/Loss, SI/CI, Time-Speed-Distance, Time & Work, Mixtures, Average, Number system	10–12
Algebra	Equations (linear/quadratic), Inequalities, Functions & graphs, Progressions (AP/GP), Word problems	8–10
Geometry & Mensuration	Triangles, Circles, Quadrilaterals, 2D & 3D mensuration (area, volume, surface area)	4–6
Statistics & Probability	Mean/Median/Mode, Standard deviation (basic), Simple probability, Permutation & Combination (basic)	4–6
Data Interpretation	Tables, Bar charts, Pie charts, Line graphs — Multi-step calculations, comparisons, percentage changes	4–6
Data Sufficiency	GMAT-style two-statement problems	2–4

5.3 Analytical Ability (15 Marks)

Type	Description
Logical Reasoning	Syllogisms, assumptions, conclusions, inference-based questions
Critical Reasoning	Strengthen/Weaken arguments (GMAT style), Flaw identification
Puzzles & Arrangements	Seating arrangements, sequencing, scheduling, blood relations
Data Interpretation	Complex charts/graphs requiring multi-step reasoning
Number/Pattern Series	Numeric or alphanumeric sequences — identify rule and next term

5.4 Writing Section (15–25 Marks)

Task	Description	Approx. Words
Essay (Academic/Business)	Argue for/against a position OR discuss a business/social issue. Structured: intro, 2–3 body paragraphs, conclusion.	300–500 words
Precis / Summary Writing	Reduce a passage to 1/3 of its length while retaining key points.	100–150 words
Paragraph Writing	Write a focused paragraph on a given topic.	150–200 words
Translation (BN ↔ EN)	Translate a given passage accurately. Assess comprehension and language skill.	100–200 words
Report Writing (rare)	Write a short business or investigative report based on a given scenario.	200–300 words

5.5 MBA Viva Voce (Interview)

Only candidates who pass the written test are called for the viva. The interview is conducted in English by IBA faculty and professionals. Key areas assessed:

Area	Likely Questions / Topics
Self Introduction	Educational background, work experience, career goals
Why MBA / Why IBA	Motivation, post-MBA plan, understanding of MBA value
Business & Economy	Bangladesh economy, banking sector, recent business news, GDP, inflation
Functional Knowledge	Marketing, Finance, HRM basics; case opinions
Current Affairs	Domestic and international events in business, economy, policy
Communication & Confidence	Clarity of speech, logical answers, handling pressure questions

SECTION 6 — IBA Executive MBA (EMBA)

The **Executive MBA (EMBA)** is designed for working professionals. Classes are held on **Fridays and Saturdays**. The test is **75 minutes** and follows a similar aptitude-based pattern.

Item	Details
Eligibility	Bachelor's in any discipline; min CGPA 2.50/4.00 or 2nd Class Min GPA 3.00/5.00 in both SSC and HSC No 3rd Division at any level Work experience preferred but not always mandatory
Test Duration	75 minutes (written test)
Sections	English Language & Communication (MCQ) Mathematics (MCQ) Analytical Ability (MCQ) Writing task (essay / composition)
Marks Distribution	English: ~30 marks Math: ~30 marks Analytical: ~15 marks Writing: ~25 marks Total: 100 marks
Interview	Shortlisted candidates called for viva voce
Class Schedule	Weekends only — Friday and Saturday
Website	iba-du.edu — EMBA Program Office, Room 405

SECTION 7 — Other Top MBA Institutions in Bangladesh

Institution	Program	Test Type	Key Focus Areas	Reputation
IBA, JU (Jahangirnagar University)	BBA / MBA	MCQ + Written 55 min	English, Math, Analytical, Bangla (basic)	Top public — 2nd best IBA
BUP (Bangladesh University of Professionals)	BBA / MBA	MCQ + Written	English, Math, General Knowledge, Reasoning	Strong in public sector & defense-affiliated careers
NSU (North South University)	MBA	Written Aptitude Test GMAT-style	Quantitative, Verbal, Analytical, Case Analysis	Best private university MBA in Bangladesh; North American curriculum
BRAC University	MBA	Admission Test + Interview	English, Math, Reasoning, Business Knowledge	Strong in development sector & international organizations
BUET (for MBM/MBA programs via BIBM)	MBA / Banking	Written + Viva	Finance, Banking, Economics, Math	Technical and engineering-oriented MBA
IBA, RU (Rajshahi University)	BBA / MBA	MCQ + Written	English, Math, GK, Analytical	Best IBA outside Dhaka
FBS, DU (Faculty of Business Studies)	BBA / MBA	DU standard test	Bangla, English, GK, Math	Large program under Dhaka University umbrella
BIBM (Bangladesh Institute of Bank Management)	MBA in Banking	Written + Interview	Banking law, Monetary policy, Finance, Math	Specialized for banking professionals

SECTION 8 — Exam Comparison Table

Feature	IBA BBA	IBA MBA	IBA EMBA	NSU MBA	BRAC MBA
Total Marks	100	100	100	100	100
Duration	2 hrs	2 hrs	75 min	2 hrs	2 hrs
English (MCQ)	30	30	30	~30	~25
Math (MCQ)	30	30	30	~30	~25
Analytical (MCQ)	15–20	15	15	~20	~20
Writing	20–25	15–25	~25	~20	~20
Viva/Interview	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Negative Marking	–0.25	–0.25	–0.25	Varies	Varies
Seats	120	~60	Varies	~100	~100
Difficulty	★★★★★	★★★★■	★★★██	★★★★■	★★★██
Competition	Extreme	Very High	High	High	Moderate

SECTION 9 — Preparation Strategy & Tips

9.1 English Preparation

- Read English newspapers daily (The Daily Star, The Financial Express)
- Study vocabulary: 10 new words per day; use flashcards or Anki
- Practice grammar from Raymond Murphy's 'English Grammar in Use'
- Solve SAT / GRE verbal practice questions for reading comprehension
- Practice timed MCQs: target 30 questions in 25–28 minutes
- Write short essays regularly; get feedback from teachers or study groups
- Learn common idioms and phrasal verbs (top 200 lists)

9.2 Mathematics Preparation

- Master the basics: percentage, ratio, profit/loss, SI/CI without a calculator
- Practice mental math: multiply, divide, and compute percentages in your head
- Solve GMAT Official Guide quant section (mirror of IBA math level)
- Focus on word problems — translate English sentences into equations
- Data Interpretation: practice reading charts in under 20 seconds; calculate fast
- Algebra: practice factoring, solving equations with speed
- Target: 30 math questions in 28 minutes (timed practice essential)

9.3 Analytical Ability Preparation

- No fixed syllabus — practice widely: number series, arrangements, critical reasoning
- Use GMAT Critical Reasoning (Official Guide) for argument-based questions
- Practice puzzles from IBA past question banks (2015–2024)
- Time yourself: average 1 minute per analytical question
- Study logical fallacies and argumentation structures

9.4 Writing Preparation

- Practice writing one essay per week on current economic/business topics
- Memorize essay structure: Hook → Context → Thesis → Body (×2) → Counterargument → Conclusion
- Read editorial sections of The Daily Star, Prothom Alo (English)
- Practice precis writing: summarize any 400-word article into 130 words
- For translation: practice Bangla-to-English conversion of news paragraphs
- Use formal academic vocabulary — avoid slang and contractions

9.5 Viva / Interview Preparation

- Practice 2-minute self-introduction in English fluently
- Prepare answers: Why MBA? Why IBA? Career plan in 5 years?
- Stay updated on Bangladesh economy: GDP, inflation, export earnings, banking sector
- Know IBA faculty names and recent research/news from IBA
- Conduct mock interviews with friends or mentors
- Speak confidently — interviewers assess communication skill, not just knowledge
- Read the Bangladesh Bank Annual Report and Economic Review summaries

9.6 Recommended Study Resources

Resource	Purpose	Availability
GMAT Official Guide (Quant + Verbal)	Best for Math & Critical Reasoning practice	Bookstores / PDF
SAT Practice Tests (College Board)	English + Math aptitude (O-Level level)	Free online
PIE Academy (blog.mypiebd.com)	IBA-specific strategies and insights	Free online
Magnus IBA (magnusiba.com)	IBA BBA & MBA prep community + circulars	Free / Paid
Saifur's / Oracle Bank Job Books	Bangladesh Bank + general bank exam MCQs	Bookstores
IBA Past Question Banks (2015–2024)	Real exam questions — best practice material	Coaching centres / PDF
Raymond Murphy Grammar	Comprehensive English grammar reference	Bookstores / PDF
Daily Star / Financial Express	Current affairs, essay ideas, vocabulary	Online / Print

SECTION 10 — AI/Data Collection Plan for IBA Prep

This section extends the Bangladesh Bank exam AI dataset pipeline to cover IBA BBA and MBA admission preparation data.

Dataset Type	Source	What to Collect
IBA BBA MCQ	IBA past papers (2015–2024), Magnus IBA, PIE Academy, coaching PDFs	Question, Options, Answer, Topic tag, Year, Explanation
IBA MBA MCQ	IBA MBA past papers, coaching notes, Studocu PDFs, Scribd	Question, Options, Answer, Section, Year, Difficulty
Writing Samples	IBA essay prompts (past), coaching model answers, Admission Guru	Prompt, Sample essay, Score (if available), Feedback notes
Viva Questions	Facebook groups (IBA aspirants), YouTube viva videos, Telegram	Question, category (intro/banking/GK), typical good answer
Grammar Rules	Raymond Murphy, British Council online, IBA error types	Rule, Example, Common mistakes, Practice MCQ
Math Shortcuts	IBA math solution books, YouTube channels (IBA specific)	Formula, Trick, Example problems, Step-by-step solution
Vocabulary Sets	Barron's 3500 words, GRE word lists, GMAT verbal sets	Word, Definition, Synonyms, Antonyms, Sentence in context
Essay Templates	Academic writing guides, IELTS band-9 essays (structure only)	Topic category, Introduction template, Body templates, Conclusion patterns

10.1 Data Collection Sources (IBA-Specific)

Source Type	Platform / Resource	Notes
PDF Question Banks	IBA past papers 2015–2024	Best quality; match real exam pattern
Online Communities	Facebook: 'IBA Admission Prep BD', 'IBA Dream' Telegram: IBA prep channels	Real repeated questions, peer explanations
Coaching Materials	Magnus IBA, PIE Academy, local coaching notes	Structured with topic tags
Video Content	YouTube: IBA solution videos, viva experience sharing	Transcribe for Q&A; extraction
Official Circulars	iba-du.edu official admission notices	Pattern changes, seat counts, date info
Comparative Data	NSU / BRAC / BUP past papers for cross-institution practice	Build adaptive difficulty model

QUICK REFERENCE SUMMARY

Program	Marks	Duration	Sections	Seats	Key Tip
IBA BBA	100	2 hrs	English 30 Math 30 Analytical 15–20 Writing 20–25	120	Speed + accuracy. Sectional cut-off is key. No guessing.
IBA MBA	100	2 hrs	English 30 Math 30 Analytical 15 Writing 15–25	~60	Business awareness + strong English writing wins viva.
IBA EMBA	100	75 min	English Math Analytical Writing	Varies	Work experience + exam score combined. Easier than regular MBA.
NSU MBA	100	2 hrs	Quant Verbal Analytical Case	~100	GMAT-style prep is ideal. North American curriculum focus.
BRAC MBA	100	2 hrs	English Math Reasoning Business	~100	Development sector focus. Strong interview performance matters.

This guide covers IBA BBA, MBA, and EMBA admissions along with top MBA institutions in Bangladesh. For the Bangladesh Bank Officer / Senior Officer / AD exam syllabus, refer to the companion document. Visit iba-du.edu for the latest official circulars before each application cycle.